

STRENGTHENING OUR GOVERNANCE

Building a common understanding of how to leverage governance with students at the center

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bombastic

OUR DAY TOGETHER

- Welcome & setting the stage
- Recap of last session, review Elements of Trust
- Navigating the Governance Ecosystem
- Lunch
- For our toolbelt: The Empowerment Dynamic
- Practicing our Skills
- Wrapping up and next steps



To be good, and to do good, is all we have to do.

- JOHN ADAMS

CONVERSATION SCAFFOLDS

01 Stay Engaged

02 Honor Ourselves, Each Other and Our Group

03 Make Space for Everyone

04 "Yes, and..." over "No, but..."

05 Don’t let the Perfect be the enemy of the Good

GET THE CONVERSATION ROLLING





RECAP OF LAST SESSION

- Reviewed OSBA Standards
- Reviewed "The Science of Student Achievement"
- Touched on "Truth Matters"

THEMES AND WONDERINGS THAT AROSE

- Strengths found in vision-directed planning, innovation/creativity, community engagement, financial leadership, data driven improvement, accountability
- Wonder: How to build a common understanding/definition of *accountability*, from systems to data to district-wide outlook?
- Wonder: What is the governance approach and philosophy? How do we align the board's work with the superintendent's + district's?
- Wonder: How to work as an effective team during an era of polycrisis?

THEMES AND WONDERINGS THAT AROSE

"Having students at the center of decision making, with a commitment to data-driven improvements lighting the way forward, creates a focus in all the diverse areas of governance responsibilities and allows the board to focus on strategy while the administrative team focuses on implementation."

WHY "TRUST MATTERS"

- Public education is people-centric work
- We must sustain support from the public, employees, students and partners in a low-trust environment
- Goals achieved only through interdependence - and interdependence brings vulnerability.



"TRUST MATTERS"

Benevolence
Caring, extending goodwill, demonstrating positive intentions, supporting teachers, staff and the Superintendent

Honesty
Showing integrity, telling the truth, keeping promises, honoring agreements, accepting responsibility

Openness
Sharing important information, delegating, sharing decision making

Reliability
Being consistent, being dependable showing commitment, expressing dedication, exercising diligence

Competence
Setting standards, dedication to the mission, working hard, setting an example, problem solving



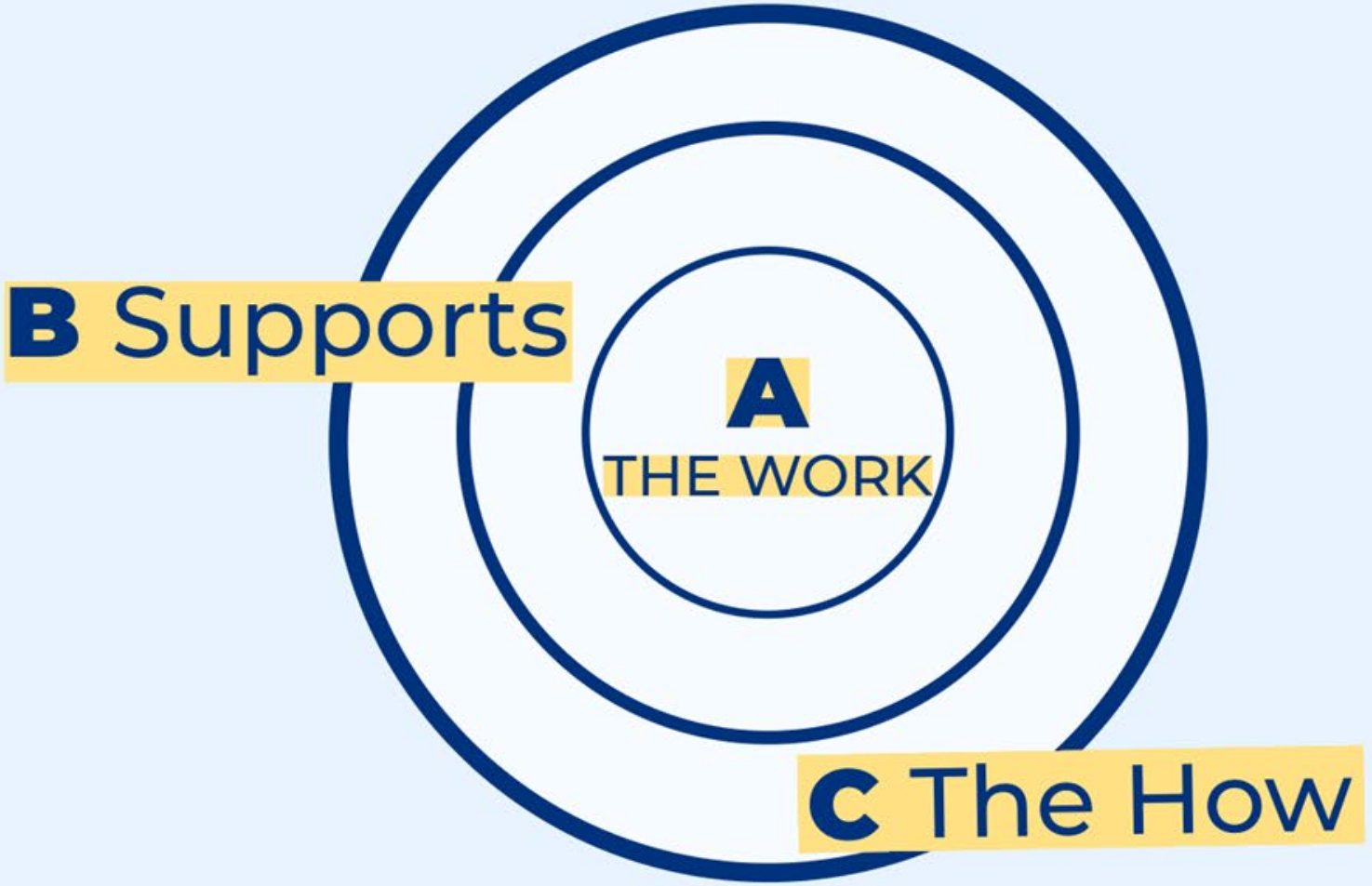
THE GOVERNANCE ECOSYSTEM

Aligning the mission, the structures, and leadership



THE ELEMENTS

From Douglas Englebart's ABC organizational model applied to school boards



THE ELEMENTS

From Douglas Englebart's ABC organizational model applied to school boards



"The Work" or "The What"

THE ELEMENTS

From Douglas Englebart's ABC organizational model applied to school boards



"The Work" or "The What"

- Goals for students
- Operational responsibilities (facilities, financial health, etc)
- Board moral, legal, fiduciary responsibilities (financial oversight, monitor progress for students, community engagement)

The Board seeks input, defines, sets parameters, fulfills responsibilities in conjunction with the Superintendent.

THE ELEMENTS

From Douglas Englebart's ABC organizational model applied to school boards



Supports, Processes, Structures = Governance

THE ELEMENTS

From Douglas Englebart's ABC organizational model applied to school boards

B Supports, Processes, Practices = Governance

- Policies that communicates and explains The What
- Processes that support monitoring, allowing adaptation over time.
- Practices that support relationships with partners, students, staff, families.
- Clarity around role of board + role of superintendent

The Board promotes processes and approaches that support growth in outcomes, in conjunction with the Superintendent.

THE ELEMENTS

From Douglas Englebart's ABC organizational model applied to school boards



"How" we think, interact, take action

THE ELEMENTS

From Douglas Englebart's ABC organizational model applied to school boards



"How" we think, interact, take action

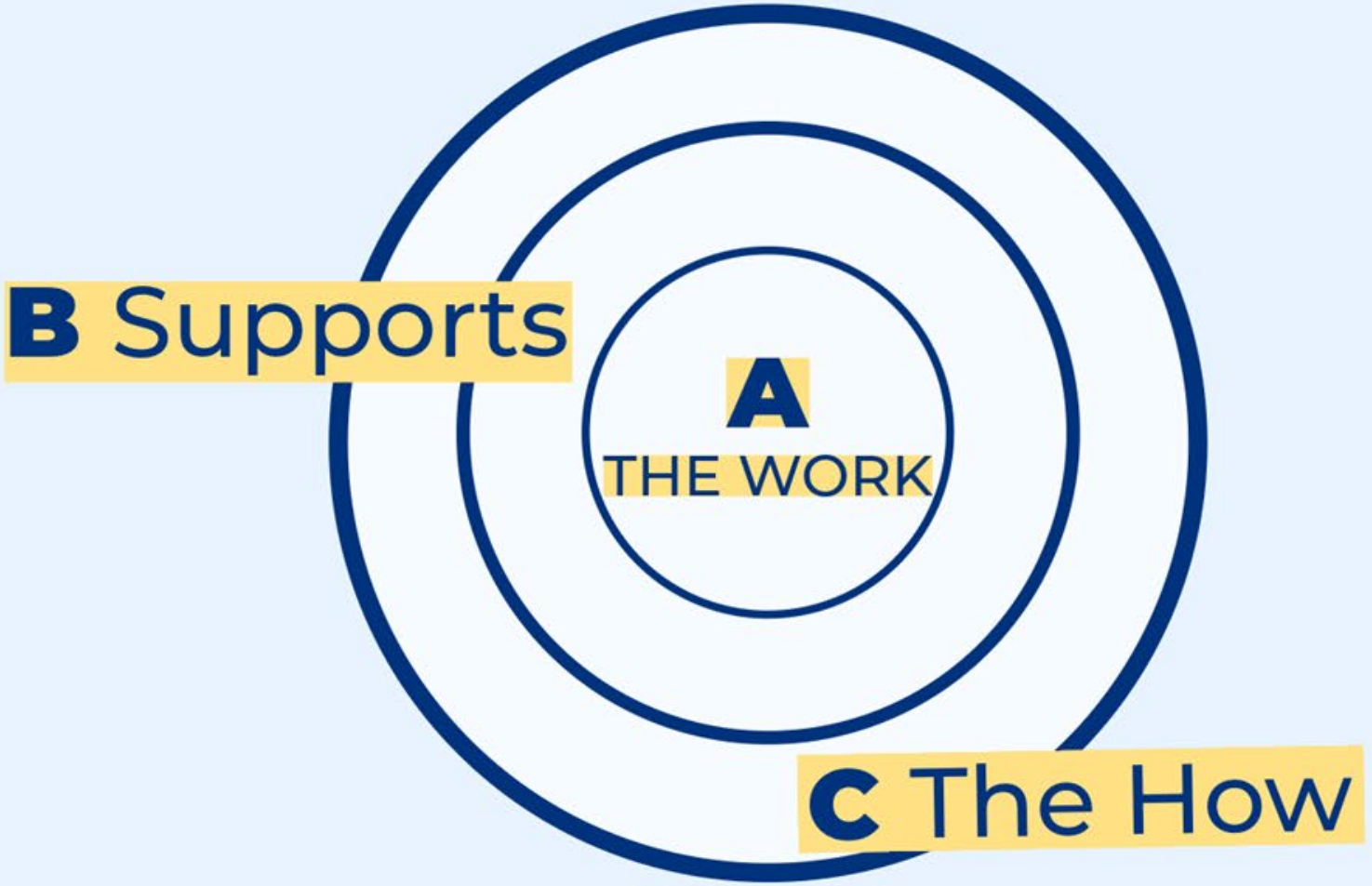
- Values light the way
- Culture and climate to support growth mindset within stressful conditions
- Trust as the grease of the gears
- Unspoken commitments
- Equity and justice at the core

The Board models The How for the entire district, learns best practices for growth, sets the tone, leads, empowers others.

THE ELEMENTS



THE ELEMENTS



LET'S APPLY!

LUNCH BREAK

“We've got a responsibility to live up to the legacy of those who came before us by doing all that we can to help those who come after us.”

MICHELLE OBAMA



WHAT IF THE "HOW" GETS STUCK?

What tools can we have when our thoughts, interactions, and actions don't support growth?



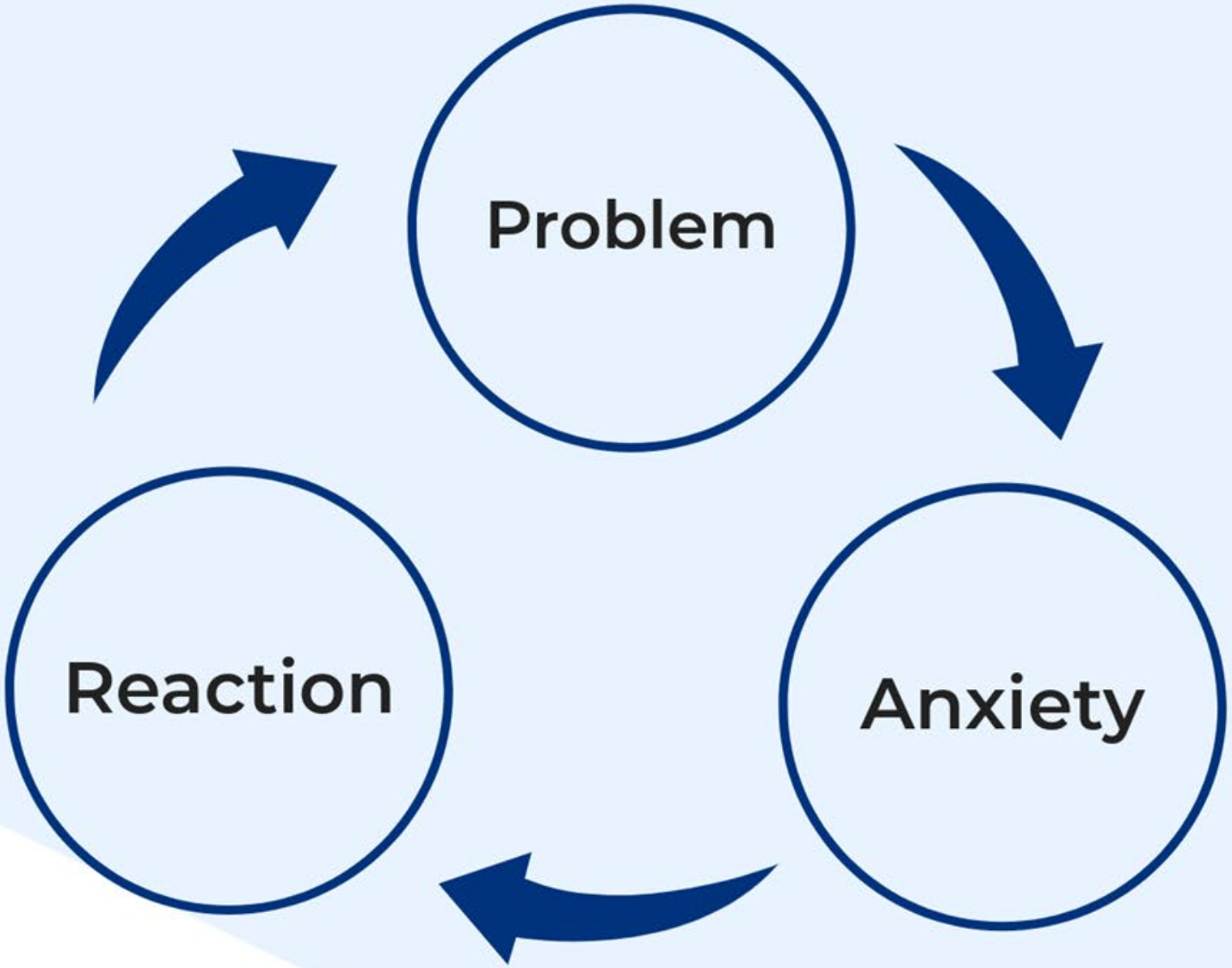
3 QUESTIONS WHEN WE ARE STUCK

01 **Where are we putting our focus:** problems or outcomes?

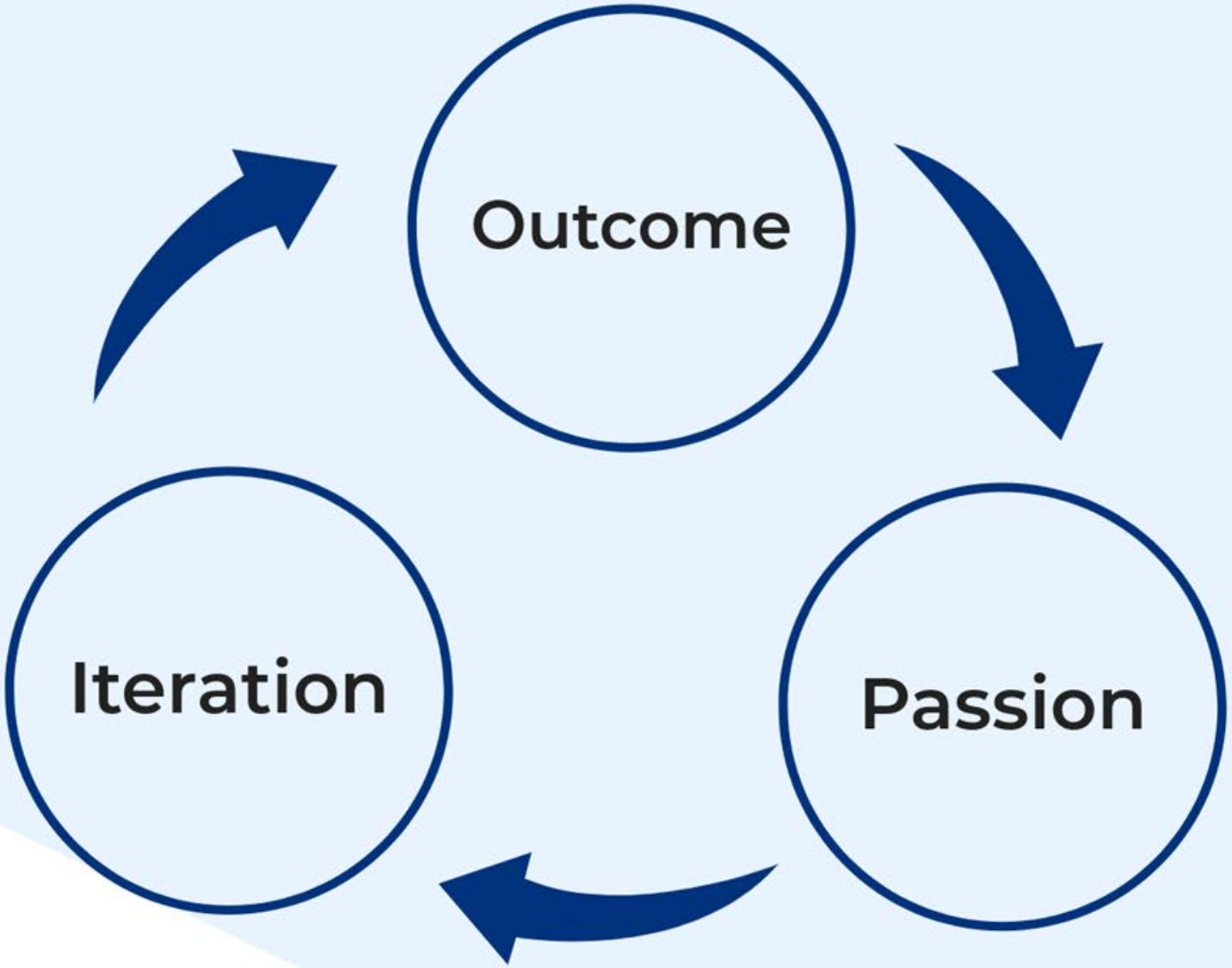
02 **How are we relating**: stuck in the status quo or empowering the team?

03 **What actions are we taking**: reacting or responding?

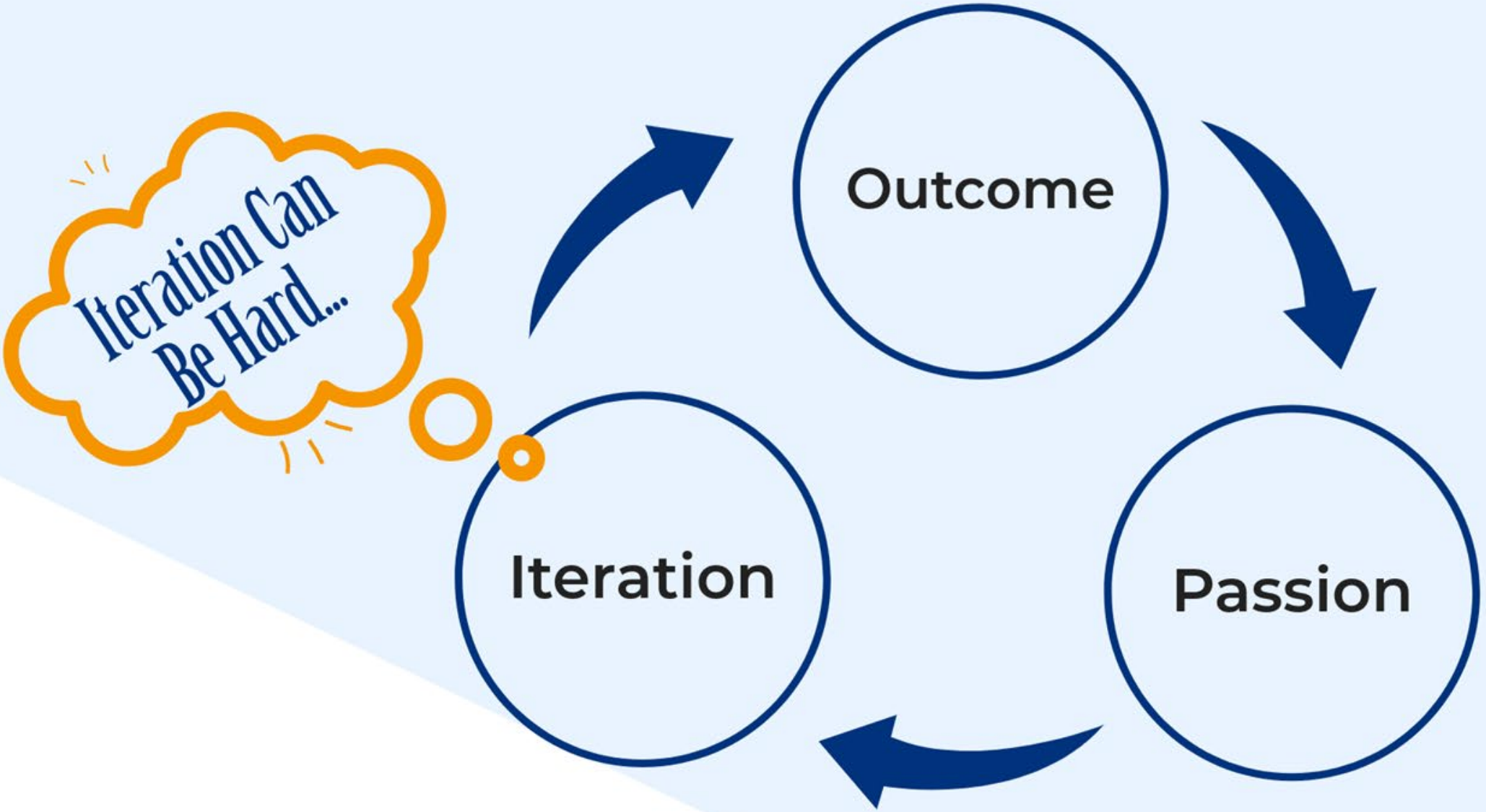
PROBLEM ORIENTATION



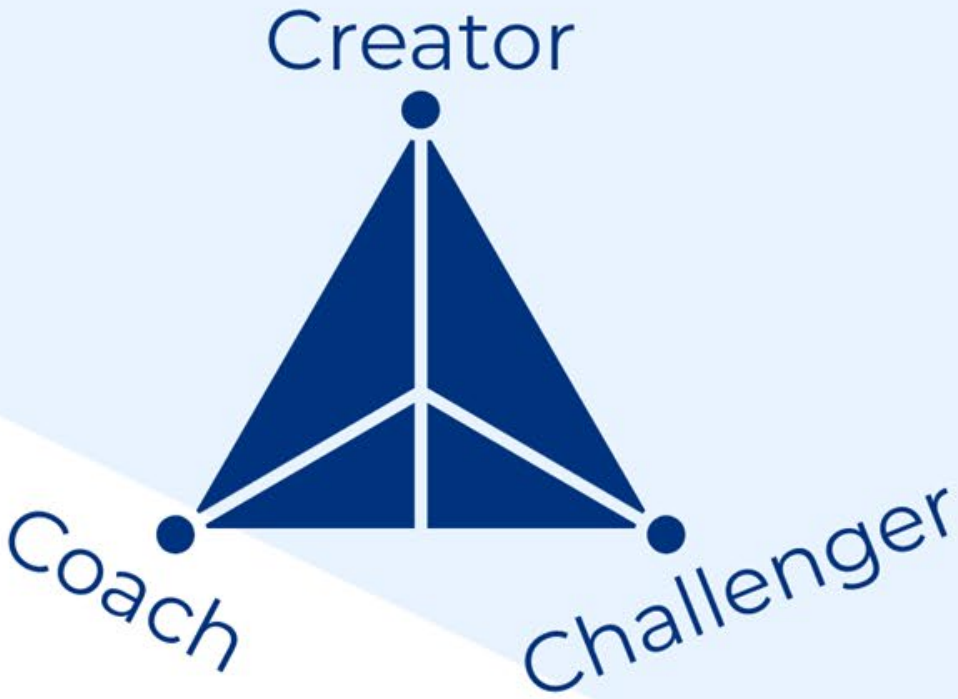
OUTCOME ORIENTATION



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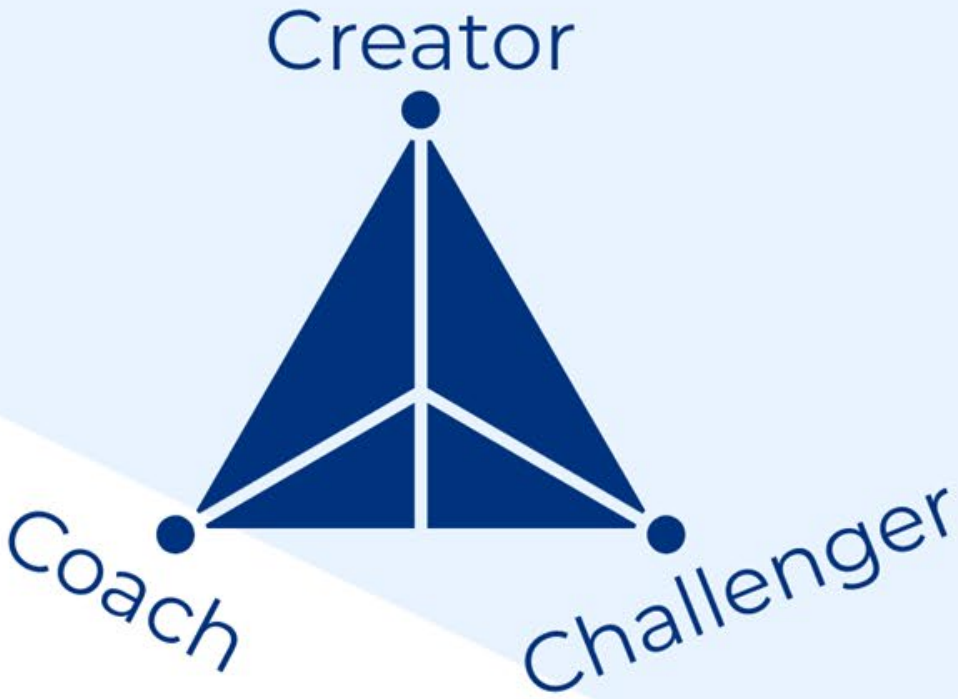
CREATE THE EMPOWERMENT DYNAMIC



Creator

- Focused on creating outcomes
- Takes responsibility for choosing how to respond

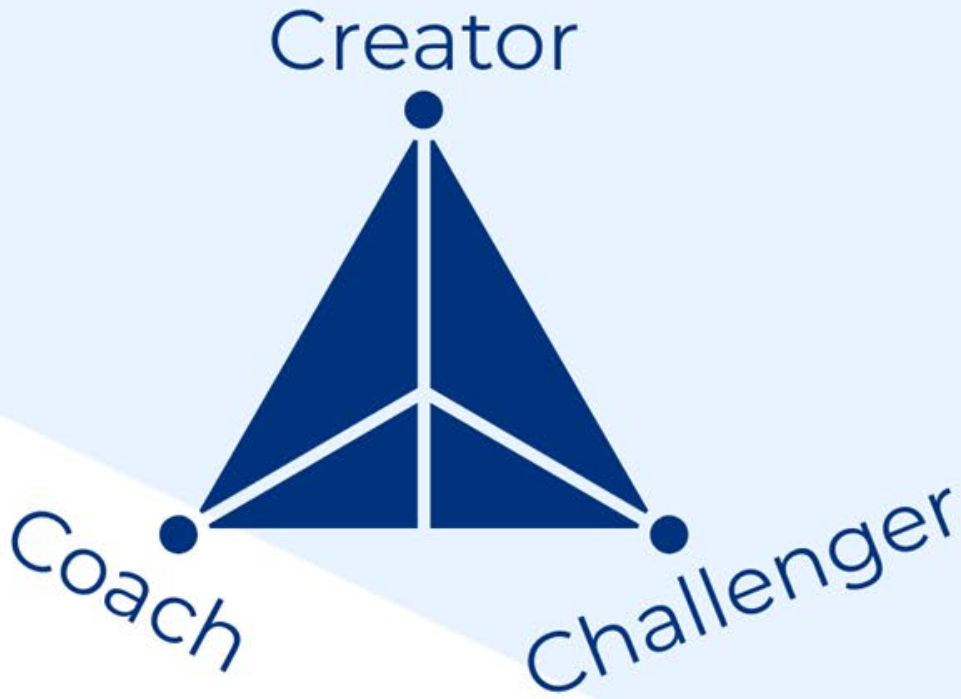
CREATE THE EMPOWERMENT DYNAMIC



Challenger

- The voice that focuses on learning and growth toward the outcome
- May be a person, or a situation (i.e. natural disaster that forces new approaches)

CREATE THE EMPOWERMENT DYNAMIC



Coach

- Asks questions to clarify outcomes, help others, thinks things through
- Respects people's agency in the process (i.e. not a Rescuer)

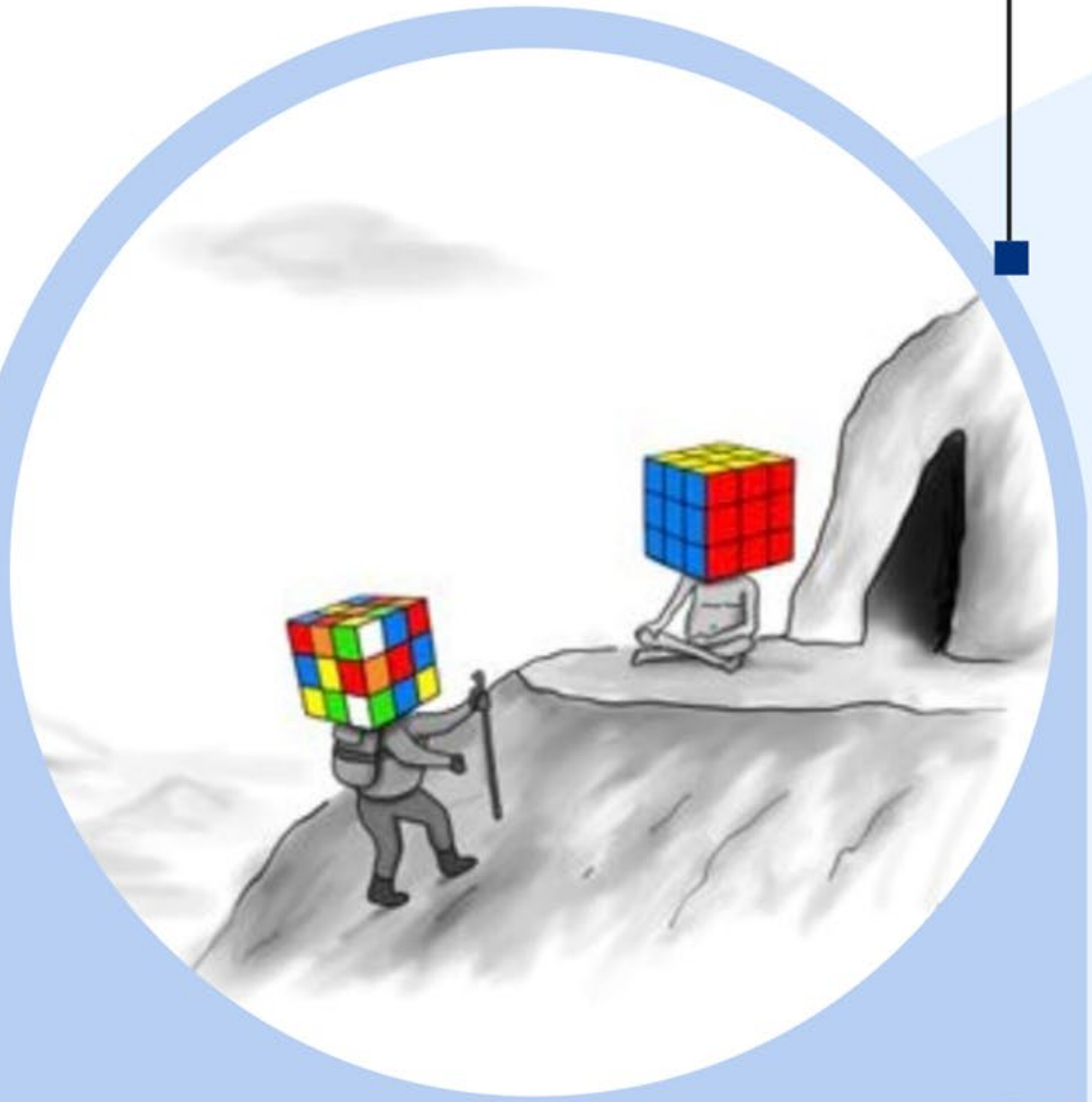
BREAK

“Do your little bit of good where you are; it's those little bits of good put together that overwhelm the world.”

DESMOND TUTU



LINING IT ALL UP



PRACTICING OUR SKILLS - DESIGNING A PROCESS

01 Discuss desired outcomes

02 Recall relevant values, commitments

03 Any constraints to remember?

04 Start with a single example

05 What other cases could happen?

06 Create draft

07 Bring back for further reflection, finalization

REFLECTING

What?
Something you learned today

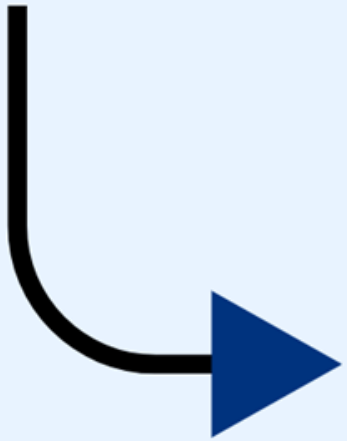
So What?
What resonated with you today

Now What?
What next steps are you looking forward to?



THANK YOU FOR OUR TIME TOGETHER.

We'd appreciate your feedback.





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